Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 2 · Monday 1 March 2027 · P5

Lesson

Choose a voice and a move

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Develop a character with voice and movement.

Today I can

I can try two ways to say a line.

I can choose one small move.

I can show my choice and why.

Prepare

For three to four pupils: one book or arts log and pencil each.

Two original example cards and the Keeper and Helper lines, read aloud if needed.

A clear seated or standing space with no contact or running.

No costume, prop, device, sound playback or recording is needed.

Keep each pupil's dated choice note for lesson two.

Cover route

Read the two original Keeper examples, show fast and slow speech at quiet talking level, then let each pupil choose a pace and a small movement. Use the seven stages. Pupils keep a real dated choice note for lesson two. A pupil may direct the adult or share privately. No costume, prop or internet is required.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Our Keeper comes to work at a table. The table has moved. That is our made-up change. You can play the Keeper or help me play it. We will keep our hands in our own space and stop at my open hand.

Look for: Pupils choose or confirm a role or a directing job. The stop signal and working space are clear.

Fallback: Offer the two role words and ask for a point. The adult performs while the pupil directs.

Check and response: Either role or a directing role is valid. Do not require a pupil to share a real experience of change.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: I say the same line in two ways, both at a quiet talking level. First fast, then slow. Which one was slow? We have changed pace, not the words.

Look for: Pupils identify a contrast in pace by word, gesture or choice.

Fallback: Say just "It has moved" twice with a very clear contrast. Use one finger for fast and two for slow.

Check and response: The second version is slow in this model. A quiet voice can be fast or slow. Loudness and pace are different.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I read or show example A, then B. I choose the slow line, "My table has moved," and an open hand to the empty spot. I want my Keeper to take time to look. Another Keeper could choose fast words. Check: did I change the words, the pace, or both?

Look for: Adult compares two versions and gives one reason. Check after the model: pupils identify that pace changed and the words stayed the same.

Fallback: Use only the short line and an open hand. Point to fast or slow and let the pupil choose the adult's next version.

Check and response: The words stayed the same; the pace changed. Both choices can work. A character's feeling cannot be known just from a hand shape.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Let us choose the pace first. Now choose an open hand or hands resting still. I perform the class choice, then we try the other pace. Hinge: which helps our Keeper look before asking for help? Give a reason. If the reason is unclear, I show the slow version with a pause and we choose again.

Look for: Each pupil makes or confirms a choice. The class links a feature to an intention; no feeling is imposed.

Fallback: Adult offers two choices and performs the confirmed direction. A pupil can point rather than act.

Check and response: A slow line and pause might show looking before asking. A fast line could also fit if the pupil explains a different intended Keeper. Accept a reason about a visible or heard feature.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use the Keeper line, "My table has moved," or the Helper line, "We can find a new spot." Practise each at two paces at talking level or below. Add one small hand move or a clear still pause. Keep the version you choose. Work with a partner, adult or alone. A silent director can choose the adult's voice and move. Record those directions as your evidence.

Look for: Two actual pace trials, one chosen pace and movement or stillness, and a confirmed reason. A directed performance is labelled as directed rather than performed by the pupil.

Fallback: Pupil points to a pace and a hand choice. Adult performs both trials and asks which to keep. Record the pupil's exact confirmed choice.

Check and response: Example only: I chose slow words and an open hand because my Keeper looks first. Any deliberate safe choice with a reason is valid. Do not copy this model as the pupil's work.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Share with one partner or just me. The listener names one thing they saw or heard: "I notice a pause." The maker says whether that was planned. Use the final two minutes to put pencils away and store each real log for tomorrow.

Look for: A factual observation is shared respectfully and the maker confirms an intention. Work is kept for lesson two.

Fallback: Adult describes the performance neutrally and asks for yes, no or a changed word. No peer audience is required.

Check and response: Useful feedback: I heard the words get slower. Avoid claims about what the pupil or character must feel.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Point to or tell me your real choice. I can write your words and read them back. Mark if you performed or directed. Keep your two trials in a brief note so we can use them next time.

Look for: Dated entry shows the role, two actual trials, chosen voice and movement, reason, and support used.

Fallback: Use one confirmed choice at a time. Adult writes a short witnessed note with the pupil's own words or gesture meaning.

Check: Example only: I directed the Keeper. I chose slow words and a still pause. Next time I will add the help line. Record only what happened today.

Evidence and review

Keep a dated arts-log entry and a precise observation of a real trial. Record what the pupil performed or directed, the chosen feature, reason, feedback and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. No supplied teacher model counts as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

A good role needs a shout - Use a clear voice at talking level or below. A quiet line can show a clear role.

Fast words always mean cross - Ask the maker what they meant. The same pace can have more than one meaning.

Directing means I did nothing - Keep the pupil's real pace and movement choices. Label the evidence as direction.

Questions

foundation: Which line was slow?

middle: What move did you choose with the line?

higher: How did that voice and move help show your role?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear a small working space. Keep both feet supported if seated. Use hands within each person's own space. No touching another performer or taking a prop from them. Sound is optional; stop on the agreed signal. Pupils can direct the adult to perform their chosen pace and movement. Record that as directed evidence, not a vocal or physical skill the pupil personally demonstrated.

Emotional and sensory access

Use the invented changed-table story. No personal story is needed. Offer seated movement, silent direction, a private adult audience and a pass on live peer performance. Voice and taps stay at talking level or below. Agree an open-hand stop signal and quiet return cue. No sudden sounds, contact, running, raised platforms, blindfolds or lifts.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Pre-teach role, pace, pause and choice with a brief model. Show one instruction at a time. Offer two pace choices, rehearse once, then fade the prompt. Use a tiny plan with beginning, change and response.

Communication And Interaction: Give processing time. Accept pointing to a pace word, signing, a phrase, a sketch or exact words scribed by an adult. Read the record back for confirmation. Do not judge accent, eye contact or facial expression.

Semh: Keep the story fictional and low stakes. A pause, a change in method or a request for help can be the character's response. Let pupils choose the role, amount of performance and audience. Follow the agreed pause-and-return route.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated hand movement and no sound. A pupil may direct an adult voice or movement. Keep each person in their own space; use no compulsory facial expression or posture. Ask before handling a pupil's work.

Eal: Plan in any language. Explain pace as how fast we speak or move. Accept first planning in a familiar language and check the intended meaning before adding English labels. The pupil may use a short English phrase or direct a partner.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. The lesson contributes evidence towards the award; it does not confer the award. Optional next level work in GROW adds skills planning, reflection and sharing evidence for later review. It is not a separate requirement for Explore success.

Resilience can mean pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying again. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or performing through pain.